

The Bylaws of the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Students Society

Last Updated: March 2026

Table of Contents

Bylaw 100 – Definitions	5
Bylaw 200 - Meetings of Council.....	6
Council.....	6
Resignation	6
Quorum	6
Term of Office	6
Scheduling Meetings	6
Rights of Participation	6
Minutes and Records of Motions	7
Council Procedures.....	7
Bylaw 300 - Chair of Council.....	9
Bylaw 400 - Council Positions	9
President	9
Vice President External.....	10
Vice President Internal	10
Directors	11
General.....	11
Bylaw 600 – Elections	11
Bylaw 610 - Oaths of Office.....	12
Bylaw 620 - Executive Member Vacancies	12
President	12
Vice President	12
All Executive	13
Director Vacancies.....	13
Bylaw 630 - Dismissal of Elected Members	13
Bylaw 640 - Dismissal of Appointed Council Members	14
Bylaw 700 - Standing Committees	14
Committee Procedures	14
Committee Membership.....	14
Committee Jurisdiction.....	15
Committee Consultation.....	15
Bylaw 710 - Ad Hoc Committees.....	16
Bylaw 720 - Executive Committee	16
Committee Mandate and Membership	16
Committee Procedures	16
Bylaw 730 – Finance Committee	17
Committee Mandate and Membership	17
Committee Procedures	17
Bylaw 740 – Student Events Committee	17

Committee Mandate and Membership	17
Committee Procedures	18
Bylaw 800 – External Committees	18
General.....	18
Lett Bursary Committee.....	18
Lett Bursary Confidentiality Agreement	18
Bylaw 900 – Society Ratification.....	19
Ratification Document.....	19
Society Training.....	19
Bylaw 1000 - Society Finances	19
Society Budget	19
Miscellaneous	19
Conflict of Interest	19
Bylaw 1100 - General Meetings.....	20
Calling & Publicizing a General Meeting	20
Meeting Procedures	20
Voting at General Meetings	20
Motions passed at General Meetings	21
Bylaw 1200 - Governance Documents	21
Adoption of New or Amended Bylaws and Policies.....	21
Constitution	21
Bylaws	21
Policies	21
Standing Rules of Council	22

Bylaw 100 – Definitions

1. In these Bylaws:

- a. “Ad Hoc Committee” means a committee of Council enacted for a limited time and specific purpose pursuant to Bylaw 710;
- b. “Budget” means the budget of the Society as enacted by Council and any amendments thereto;
- c. “Campus” means any collection of buildings where a significant amount of teaching and/or research activities of the University are conducted.
- d. “Chair” means a Chairperson;
- e. “Chair of Council” the elected member responsible for presiding over meetings and guiding discussions within the council, and includes any acting Chair of Council;
- f. “Closed session” means a meeting, or part thereof, of Council (or a Committee) that is open only to Council Members (or Committee Members), staff, and any Guests included under a separate and seconded motion receiving a two-thirds majority vote of Council (or a Committee).
- g. “Committee” means a Standing Committee or an Ad Hoc Committee;
- h. “Committee Meeting” means a meeting of a Standing Committee or an Ad Hoc Committee;
- i. “Committee Member” means a member of a Standing Committee or an Ad Hoc Committee;
- j. “Council” means the Board of Directors as described in Bylaw 400;
- k. “Council Meeting” means a meeting of Council;
- l. “Council Member” means any voting member of Council elected in accordance to Bylaw 600;
- m. “Department” means the Department of Mathematics and Statistics at Dalhousie University.
- n. “Director” means one or more of the Director of Mathematics (Master), Director of Mathematics (Doctoral), Director of Statistics (Master), and Director of Statistics (Doctoral);
- o. “DSU” means the Dalhousie Student Union;
- p. “Elected Member of Council” means any Council Member who was voted into their position at an Annual General Meeting.
- q. “Executive” means the President, Vice President External, and the Vice President Internal;
- r. “Ex-officio Member” means someone who is a member of a Committee or Council by virtue of his or her office, and who has all of the rights and privileges of the other Committee Members or Council Members except those rights removed by the Bylaws;
- s. “In camera” means a meeting, or part thereof, of Council (or a Committee) that is only open to Council Members (or Committee Members), staff, and any Guests included under a separate and seconded motion receiving a two-thirds majority vote.
- t. “Members of the Society” means all persons enrolled in either a part- or full-time graduate program in the Mathematics and Statistics department at Dalhousie University;
- u. “Minute Record” means a record kept by Council containing complete and accurate minutes of all Council Meetings;
- v. “Open Session” means a meeting, or part thereof, of Council (or a Committee) that is open to Council Members (or Committee Members) and any Guests;

- w. "Program Member" means a Member of the Society in a particular program of the Department;
- x. "Standing Committee" means a standing committee of Council enacted by these Bylaws;
- y. "Society" means the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Student **Society**;
- z. "University" means Dalhousie University;

Bylaw 200 - Meetings of Council

Council

1. Council Members shall be:
 - a. The Executive:
 - i. President
 - ii. Vice President External
 - iii. Vice President Internal
 - b. One Director from each of the post-graduate programs, who is a member of the Society:
 - i. Mathematics (Master)
 - ii. Mathematics (Doctoral)
 - iii. Statistics (Master)
 - iv. Statistics (Doctoral)
2. No Member of Council shall hold more than one seat on Council.

Resignation

3. A Council Member may resign their office at any time by notifying the Chair of Council in writing. If no specific date is given for the resignation to take effect, it shall take effect 14 days after the notice is given to the Chair of Council.

Quorum

4. Quorum for a Council Meeting shall be no less than fifty percent (50%) of the total number of Council Members.
5. Non-voting or ex-officio Members shall not count towards quorum at any Council meeting.

Term of Office

6. A Council Member's term of office shall commence the day after the Annual General Meeting in the year the Member is elected.
7. A Council Member's term of office shall expire on the day of the Annual General Meeting of the following year.

Scheduling Meetings

8. Council Meetings shall be held when requested by any Council member.

Rights of Participation

10. Members of the Society have, subject to any other provisions in the Bylaws, full rights to:
 - a. attend Council Meetings in Open Session;
 - b. make presentations
 - c. serve on and vote in Ad-Hoc Committees where appointed by the Council; and

- d. have any other rights granted to a member of an assembly under the Robert's Rules of Order except voting rights in Council.
- 11. Council Members have, subject to any other provisions in the Bylaws, full rights to:
 - a. attend Council Meetings;
 - b. speak, make and second motions;
 - c. vote in Council Meetings;
 - d. serve on and vote in Standing and Ad-Hoc Committees where appointed or elected; and
 - e. have any other rights granted to a member of an assembly under the Robert's Rules of Order.
- 12. Guests have, subject to any other provisions in the Bylaws, rights to:
 - a. attend Council meetings at the discretion of the Chair, excluding closed session portions of any meeting;
- 13. Any Council Meeting or part thereof may be held in closed session (i.e., in camera) on motion of Council, but no motions may be passed while in camera.

Minutes and Records of Motions

- 14. Council shall take accurate minutes of the proceedings including discussions, documents, presentations, reports et cetera, of all Council Meetings in open session. These minutes shall be:
 - a. kept in the Minute Record, which shall also include a list of all motions passed and defeated by Council in Open Session;
 - b. signed by the two of: the mover, the seconder of the minutes;
 - c. copied (electronic or hard copy) and provided to every Council Member and to any other Member of the Society who requests copies thereof;
 - d. made available for Members of the Society to access.
- 15. Council shall take accurate minutes of the proceedings including discussions, documents, presentations, reports et cetera, of all Council Meetings in closed session. These minutes shall be:
 - a. kept in a separate, confidential Minute Record, which shall also include a list of all motions passed and defeated by Council in Closed Session;
 - b. signed by the mover, the seconder of the minutes and/or the chairperson;
 - c. copied and provided to every Council Member;
 - d. made available for Council Members to access.
- 16. Council may take accurate notes of the proceedings including discussions, documents, presentations, reports et cetera, of all Council Meetings in-camera session. If notes are requested, these notes shall be:
 - a. kept in a sealed envelope which shall include a list of those present and the date of the meeting.
 - b. written by hand.
 - c. not copied.
 - d. available to only those Council Members present to access.

Council Procedures

- 17. Voting at Council Meetings shall be by show of hands except where the Bylaws or the Robert's Rules of Order require a secret ballot vote.
- 18. The governance documents of the Society are ranked as follows in descending authority:
 - a. The MSGSS Constitution;
 - b. The Bylaws of the Society;
 - c. The Policies of the Society;

- d. Standing orders of Council;
 - e. Robert's Rules of Order.
19. The following shall be the order by which motions at Council Meetings shall proceed as far as may be considered practicable by the Chair of Council:
- a. The motion is submitted to Council in one of two ways:
 - i. Any Council Member may make a motion to Council. Motions must be dealt with under a respective agenda item.
 - ii. Committees may also forward motions to Council. All motions shall be provided to the Chair of Council, by the Committee Chair, with sufficient time to permit the Chair of Council to include the item on the agenda for the Council meeting at which the motion is to be made.
 - b. Motions that have been moved and seconded by Council Members shall be referred to the appropriate Committee as decided by the Chair of Council;
 - c. If referred to Committee, the motion is discussed, explored and the Committee may decide, at a later time to be determined by a majority vote in Committee, to
 - i. bring the motion to Council verbatim;
 - ii. bring the motion back to Council with amendment(s) and explanation of said amendment(s); or
 - iii. table the motion.
 - d. Debate of a motion by Council and Members of the Society shall follow:
 - i. speaking turns by Council Members shall be no longer than 4 minutes in duration and each Council Member shall be limited to 1 speaking turn;
 - ii. A Council Member or a Member of the Society may be granted a second, and last speaking turn on the condition that the second speaking turn only arises after any other Council Member who wishes to speak has exercised his or her rights to do so; Council shall vote on the motion.
20. Upon the expiration of the speaking limit set, any Council Member may make a motion to extend the speaking limit. Any such motion to extend the time limit is not subject to debate and shall only pass by a 2/3 majority vote of Council.
21. Subject to any other provisions in the Bylaws, the following shall be, as far as may be considered practicable by the Chairperson, the order of business at Council Meetings:
- a. determination of attendance and determination of quorum or rescheduling of the Council Meeting;
 - b. approval of the agenda;
 - c. approval of the minutes of the previous Council Meeting;
 - d. presentations and correspondence;
 - e. reports from Committees;
 - f. reports of the Executive;
 - g. reports of the Directors;
 - h. unfinished business arising from the minutes of the previous Council Meeting;
 - i. regular business;
 - j. business arising from reports
 - k. announcements
 - l. adjournment.
22. The Chair of Council, at his or her discretion, may ask the Chair of the Committee considering any motion for a verbal progress report.

Bylaw 300 - Chair of Council

1. The President of the Council shall be the Chair of Council unless otherwise indicated by the Council.
2. In the absence of the President, one of the Vice Presidents shall act as Chair.
3. The duties of the Chair of Council shall include the following:
 - a. call to order all Council Meetings;
 - b. chair all Council Meetings;
 - c. receive agenda items and prepare the agenda for Council Meetings;
 - d. take attendance at Council Meetings;
 - e. conduct Council Meetings in accordance with the Bylaws, Policies, and any Standing Rules of Council, and Robert's Rules of Order;
 - f. present all motions and resolutions requiring a vote by Council, and record the votes cast on those motions and resolutions;
 - g. recognize Council Members and other persons desiring to address a Council Meeting as guests of Council and maintain a speaker list using the general criteria outlined in the Robert's Rules of Order;
 - h. declare all motions that are passed or defeated by Council;
 - i. advance publication of notices of Council Meetings in accordance with the Bylaws, Policies and any Standing Rules of Council; and
 - j. advise all Committees on procedural matters.
4. In the absence of an executive member, a member of the council, as selected by Council, shall act as Chair.
5. The Chair of Council shall only vote in the event of a tie and only if an Elected Member of Council.

Bylaw 400 - Council Positions

President

1. Subject to other provisions in the Bylaws, the President shall be responsible for the overall operation of the Society. Without restricting the generality of the foregoing, the President shall be responsible for:
 - a. acting as the main Society spokesperson on all Society issues;
 - b. presenting the Society with a viewpoint of persons and groups outside of the Department;
 - c. advocating the Society's interests in the Department, Lett Bursary, and any other committees of the Department of which the President is a member or whom the President has an opportunity to address;
 - d. providing input to all Committees;
 - e. chair of Council;
 - f. chairing the Executive Committee;
 - g. providing input to all of the Society's businesses;
 - h. providing long term strategic direction for the Society;
 - i. serving as a signing authority of the Society;
 - j. ensuring that any programs of Council and the Society are implemented in accordance with motions of Council, the Bylaws, and Policies;
 - k. furthering and maintaining good working relationships with Members of the Society, Department, and other student societies and/or student associations and/or student federations;

- l. serving as a liaison between the Society and any external organizations; and
- m. performing any other duties and responsibilities as directed by the Bylaws or Council.

Vice President External

- 2. Subject to any other provisions in the Bylaws, the Vice-President External shall be responsible for overseeing all programming activities of the Society, and overseeing all Society communications. Without restricting the generality of the foregoing, the Vice-President External shall be responsible for:
 - a. overseeing all communications with the Members of the Society, including, but not limited to, electronic communications and newsletters;
 - b. overseeing the production of all Society publications including, but not limited to, newsletters;
 - c. overseeing all promotional materials of the Society;
 - d. chairing meetings of the Student Events Committee;
 - e. overseeing the Society's programming events, ensuring they cater to the academic, cultural, and social interests of the Members of the Society;
 - f. overseeing the promotion of Society events within the Department, University, and outside of Campus;
 - g. overseeing all external communications, including press releases, with the President;
 - h. serving as a signing authority of the Society;
 - i. in conjunction with the President, serving as a liaison between the Society and any external organizations;
 - j. performing any other duties and responsibilities as directed by the Bylaws, the President or Council.

Vice President Internal

- 3. Subject to any other provisions in the Bylaws, the Vice-President Internal shall be responsible for the Society's internal matters, including the budget, overseeing the proper operation of any Society services and businesses, representation, and Society bylaws and policies. Without restricting the generality of the foregoing, the Vice-President Internal shall be responsible for:
 - a. overseeing all financial management of the Society, including preparing and maintaining the budget (in conjunction with the President), and keep records of all receipts and expenditures of the society.
 - b. Gather and submit all audit materials to the DSU. These materials normally include an audit cover letter, general ledger, cheque book, monthly bank reconciliations, bank statements, transaction records for all transactions, Budget, and minutes. The DSU may request other documents.
 - c. take the minutes of the Council and Executive Meetings.
 - d. acting as chair of the Finance Committee;
 - e. maintaining all Society bylaws, policies and standing procedures, including implementation of such rules with the president;
 - f. overseeing the operations of all Society businesses;
 - g. serving as a signing authority of the Society;
 - h. advising Members of the Society on academic and disciplinary appeals and related matters, and acting as the official Student Advocate;
 - i. advocating the Society's interests in the Department, Lett Bursary, and any other committees of the Department of which the Vice President Internal is a member or whom the Vice President Internal has an opportunity to address;

- j. serving as a liaison between the Society and administration of the Department, developing and maintaining a good working relationship, and when appropriate lobbying them on behalf of the Society;
- k. overseeing all academic issues that arise from members of the Society; and
- l. performing any other duties and responsibilities as directed by the Bylaws, the President or Council.

Directors

- 4. Subject to any other provisions in the Bylaws, the Directors shall represent that Member of the Society in their respective program on Council. Without restricting the generality of the foregoing, each Director shall be responsible for:
 - a. Serving as the liaison between the Council and the Members of the Society;
 - b. overseeing the planning of the graduate mathematics and statistics seminar; and
 - c. performing any other duties and responsibilities as directed by the Bylaws, the President or Council.

General

- 5. Council Members may request to delegate responsibilities to other Council Members or to the Chair of Council to perform as needed. These requests must be approved by the individual to whom the responsibility is being delegated as well as a majority of the Executive Committee as a whole. The delegated authority can be revoked at any time.

Bylaw 600 – Elections

- 1. Election of Council shall be held during the Annual General Meeting. The current year's President shall be responsible for running the elections.
- 2. If the current year's President wishes to run, any member of the current year's executive shall be responsible for running the elections. If there are no Members of Executive who are able to run the elections, a Member of the Society shall be appointed by motion of the Annual General Meeting to run the election.
- 3. Election of a Member of Council shall be by secret ballot.
- 4. A member shall be considered elected to office on obtaining more than 50% of the votes cast. In the event that no nominee obtains more than 50% of the vote, the nominee receiving the fewest votes, nominees receiving less than 10% of the vote, and any nominee who wishes to withdrawal, shall be removed from the race. In the event that two nominees each receive 50% of the vote, then the winner of the election shall be decided by a random draw.
- 5. Each member can only hold one position on Council.
- 6. A person may be nominated in absentia for a Council position, provided they have a reasonable excuse for their absence and have already provided written acceptance of the nomination.
- 7. Nominations for Members of Council shall be accepted during the Annual General Meeting.
- 8. Nominations for Members of the Executive must be moved and seconded by any other Member of the Society. All Member of the Society may vote for any Executive member nominee.
- 9. Nominations for Directors must be moved and seconded by Members of the Society in that particular program. For example, only students who are in a Mathematics Master's program may be nominated for, seconded by, and voted by Members of the Society in a Mathematics Master's Program.

Bylaw 610 - Oaths of Office

1. The Council Members, prior to the commencement of their official duties, shall take an Oath of Office. Failure to do so shall preclude the President and/or Vice-Presidents from carrying out their duties as prescribed by the Bylaws of the Society, subject to any other provisions of the Bylaws of the Society.
2. The Chair of Council shall administer the Oath. In the absence of the Chair.
3. The President and Vice-Presidents shall take their respective Oaths of Office at the first a Council meeting after being elected into their positions.
4. The Oath of Office for the President shall be: I, (name), do hereby promise that I will diligently, faithfully, and to the best of my ability fulfill the duties, responsibilities, and expectations of the office of the President of the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Student **Society**, in accordance with the Bylaws of the Society, and above all else in the best interests of the members who belong to the Society. I humbly acknowledge and accept the great privilege and honour bestowed upon me, and shall not violate the trust placed in me by Council and the Members of the Society.
5. The Oath of Office for the Vice Presidents shall be: I, (name), do hereby promise that I will diligently, faithfully, and to the best of my ability fulfill the duties, responsibilities, and expectations of the Office of the Vice President (position title) of the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Student Society, in accordance with the Bylaws of the Society, and above all else in the best interests of the members who belong to the Society. I humbly acknowledge and accept the great privilege and honour bestowed upon me, and shall not violate the trust placed in me by Council and the Members of the Society.
6. The Oath of Office for the Directors shall be: I, (name), do hereby promise that I will diligently, faithfully, and to the best of my ability fulfill the duties, responsibilities, and expectations of the Office of the (position title) Director of the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Student Society, in accordance with the Bylaws of the Society, and above all else in the best interests of the members who belong to the Society. I humbly acknowledge and accept the great privilege and honour bestowed upon me, and shall not violate the trust placed in me by Council and the Members of the Society.
7. In the event of the resignation, dismissal, and incapacitation of any Member(s) of Council, the interim or newly Member(s) of Council is entitled to carry out the duties of that office immediately and must take the Oath of Office at the earliest Council meeting possible.

Bylaw 620 - Executive Member Vacancies

President

1. If the President resigns or becomes incapacitated, or if the position of the President remains vacant after the Annual General Meeting:
 - a. a Vice President shall be appointed to be an interim President by the Council;
 - b. a by-election for the vacated President position shall be held at the next General Meeting, which shall not be more than one (1) month after the vacancy commences.
 - c. said by-election shall be held in accordance with the Election Bylaws.

Vice President

2. Should a Vice President resign or become incapacitated during the term of his or her office, or if the position of the Vice President remains vacant after the Annual General Election,
 - a. the Council shall appoint a Member of the Society as interim Vice President.

- b. a by-election for the vacated Vice President position shall be held at the next General Meeting, which shall not be more than one (1) month after the vacancy commences.
- c. said by-election shall be held in accordance with the Election Bylaws.

All Executive

- 3. In the event that all executive members were to resign or become incapacitated after the Annual General Elections, Council would appoint an interim President until a by-election is completed.
- 4. A by-election for the vacated executive positions shall be held at the next General Meeting, which shall not be more than one (1) month after the vacancies commences.

Director Vacancies

- 5. If a Director resigns or becomes incapacitated, or if a Director position remains vacant after the Annual General Meeting:
 - a. nominations to fill the position by appointment of Council shall reopen the first day after the vacancy.
 - b. The application period shall be one week.
 - c. If, by the end of the application period:
 - i. no one has applied or no suitable applicants were received, the Council may make a ruling to re-open the posting or leave the position vacant until the next election
 - ii. one or more people have applied, the Executive shall interview and make a recommendation to Council.
- 6. If the position becomes vacant within the first six months of their term, the candidate appointed by Council shall be appointed until the next General Meeting, where the vacant position will be open for nominations. This General Meeting shall be held in March at the latest.
- 7. If the position becomes vacant after the first six (6) months of their term, the candidate appointed by Council shall be appointed until the next Annual General Meeting.
- 8. Appointed Members of Council shall have full voting rights during their term in office.

Bylaw 630 - Dismissal of Elected Members

- 1. Members of Council can only be dismissed by way of petition.
- 2. A petition to dismiss a member of the Executive requires the signatures of at least five (5) Members of the Society.
- 3. A petition to dismiss a Director requires the signatures of either five (5) Program Members, or 50% of the Program Members, which ever is least.
- 4. A petition to dismiss a Member of Council shall be worded as follows: "We, the undersigned, petition the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Student Society to remove (insert name of the member(s)) from position as (insert position) of the Dalhousie Mathematics and Statistics Graduate Student Society".
- 5. Once a petition is received and deemed valid, a General Meeting shall be held within thirty (30) days of obtaining the petition. The motion to impeach must be voted on and obtaining more than 50% of the votes cast.
- 6. Voting on a motion to impeach must be done by secret ballad.
- 7. If a Member or Members of Council is/are dismissed, any resulting vacancy shall be dealt with, as far as practical, in accordance with Bylaw 620 as if the Society member(s) had resigned.
- 8. Amendments to this bylaw shall not take effect until the following Annual General Meeting.

Bylaw 640 - Dismissal of Appointed Council Members

1. An appointed Council Member may be dismissed, on motion to Council, for any reason determined appropriate by Council, and without restricting the generality of the foregoing may include any 1 or more of the following reasons:
 - a. the appointed Council Member has repeatedly acted in a manner that is unduly disruptive and disrespectful of Council and its proceedings;
 - b. the appointed Council Member ceases to be a member of the society;
 - c. any appointed council member unable to attend meetings that would result in their removal as outlined in this bylaw may make a request to the full council to excuse their absences shall normally be requested prior but may be considered by the discretion of the council afterwards.
2. Removal of an appointed Council Member is subject to the following procedure:
 - a. a notice of motion to dismiss is made to Council by a Member of the Society, which includes the reasons for the proposed dismissal, shall be served at a Council Meeting and shall be dealt with at the following meeting.
3. A motion to remove an appointed Council Member shall only pass by a majority vote of Council members present at the meeting.

Bylaw 700 - Standing Committees

1. There shall be the following Standing Committees:
 - a. Executive Committee;
 - b. Finance Committee;
 - c. Student Events Committee;
2. The remainder of Bylaw 700 shall apply to all Standing Committees except where overruled by the Bylaw referring to the specific Standing Committee.

Committee Procedures

3. Quorum for Standing Committee Meetings shall be no less than 50% of all voting Members of the Standing Committee including the Chair.
4. The governance documents of the Society are ranked as follows in terms of descending order of authority for the purposes of a Standing Committee meeting:
 - a. The Constitution of the Society;
 - b. The Bylaws of the Society;
 - c. The Policies of the Society;
 - d. Standing orders of Council specifically regarding Committees;
 - e. Standing orders of the respective Society Committee;
 - f. Robert's Rules of Order.
5. Except where otherwise stated in the Bylaws, all standing committee meetings shall be set with no less than 2 working days' notice to voting members, and such notice shall include the agenda, minutes, and any and all related materials related to the agenda be it in draft or final report form. This includes, but is not limited to reports, motions, papers and presentations.

Committee Membership

6. The term of a Standing Committee Member shall commence upon appointment and shall expire at the end of the Member of Council's term, or should the Member be removed from Council

as outlined in the bylaws. If a Member of a Standing Committee is not a Member of Council, their term will end on the day of next year's Annual General Meeting.

7. Every council member shall typically be a Member of at least one (1) Standing Committees.
8. If a member of a committee misses three (3) consecutive standing committee meetings without regrets or a total of six (6) standing committee meetings without regrets within their term on the said committee, their membership on that standing committee shall go to a vote of council.
9. The President shall be a non-voting ex-officio member of every Standing Committee.
10. The Chair of every Standing Committee shall:
 - a. call a Standing Committee Meetings whenever a Member of that Standing Committee requests a meeting
 - b. receive all correspondence directed to the Standing Committee;
 - c. present, at every Council Meeting, a report on the activities of the Standing Committee occurring since the Standing Committee's last report to Council;
 - d. ensure that any motions which the Standing Committee makes to Council are presented to Council in typewritten format;
 - e. report to Council on the overall attendance record of all Standing Committee Members;
 - f. if there is an ongoing problem meeting quorum, make a motion to Council that one (1) or more Standing Committee Members be replaced or re-strike the Standing Committee; and
 - g. arrange for the Standing Committee to receive presentations from any Members of the Society including Council Members on any issue within the jurisdiction and mandate of the particular Standing Committee for the purpose of determining whether the Standing Committee will make a motion to Council at any Council Meeting.
11. Non-voting Members shall not act as Chair of any Committee Meeting except where provided for elsewhere in these Bylaws.
12. Standing Committees may have Members of the Society as voting members of the Committee as decided Council.

Committee Jurisdiction

13. Standing Committees may only make motions with respect to matters within their jurisdiction and mandate.
14. It is within the exclusive jurisdiction of every Standing Committee to determine whether it will make a motion to Council on a matter within its jurisdiction and mandate.

Committee Consultation

15. Where possible and expedient, the Executive Committee shall consult with other Committees on matters that may touch on their jurisdiction. Nothing in the Bylaws prevents the Executive Committee from making any motion to Council with respect to matters that may touch upon the jurisdiction of other Committees; however, Council may direct the Executive Committee to place the matter before any other Committee for review and consideration.
16. Standing Committee Meetings shall be open to the Members of the Society unless the Standing Committee determines to have an in camera or closed session.
17. Any Standing Committee may consult with other Committees, Members of Council, Members of the Society, or any other person who it considers appropriate, provided that resource does not charge money for their services.

18. Standing Committees may enact their own procedures and requirements for accepting recommendations and seeking advice from others in considering whether to make motions to Council for the adoption of Policies or Bylaws.

Bylaw 710 - Ad Hoc Committees

1. Council may enact Ad Hoc Committees at any time and for any purpose as considered necessary by Council or where required by the Bylaws.
2. Bylaw 700 also applies to Ad Hoc Committees, except where superseded by either part of Bylaw 710 or by the terms of reference of the Ad Hoc Committee. References to 'Standing Committees' in Bylaw 700 should be taken to refer also to Ad Hoc Committees for the purposes of this clause.
3. Any enactment of an Ad Hoc Committee shall include:
 - a. the mandate of the Ad Hoc Committee;
 - b. the date the Ad Hoc Committee shall be enacted;
 - c. the date the Ad Hoc Committee shall be dissolved;
 - d. the Ad Hoc Committee Members or the method by which the Ad Hoc Committee Members shall be selected; and
 - e. the quorum for Ad Hoc Committee Meetings.
4. All Ad Hoc Committees shall consist of at least two (2) Members of Council.

Bylaw 720 - Executive Committee

Committee Mandate and Membership

1. The mandate of the Executive Committee is to oversee and administer the day-to-day affairs of the Society, to make decisions as needed between meetings of Council, and to represent the collective opinion of the Executive.
2. The Executive Committee shall be composed of the following:
 - a. the President;
 - b. the Vice-President Internal; and
 - c. the Vice-President External.
3. The Executive Committee shall consider matters relating to the following subjects:
 - a. other personnel matters relating to the Society;
 - b. legal issues;
 - c. agenda preparation for Council Meetings;
 - d. policy and bylaw revision; and
 - e. other issues that arise throughout the year.

Committee Procedures

4. The President shall be the Chair of the Executive Committee. In the absence of the President, the Vice President Internal shall be the Chair of the Executive Committee.
5. All meetings of the Executive Committee shall be in closed session unless otherwise decided upon by the Committee.
6. The Executive Committee shall meet whenever a Member of the Executive requests a meeting.
7. Any financial commitments, contract issue, and other matters of importance as determined by the executive must be recorded in the minutes.

Bylaw 730 – Finance Committee

Committee Mandate and Membership

1. The mandate of the Finance Committee is review the financial affairs of the Society
2. The Finance Committee shall be composed of:
 - a. the Vice-President (Internal), as Chair;
 - b. a minimum of two (2) Council Members appointed by Council.
 - c. any Member of the Society may be a Finance Committee Member if appointed by Council.
3. The Finance Committee shall consider matters relating to the following subjects:
 - a. presentation of, and amendments to, the Budget;
 - b. approval of financial statements;
 - c. approval of monthly cheque details;
 - d. monthly reconciliations;
 - e. the exercise of any right attached to a security, and the acquisition and disposition of securities;
 - f. scrutinize the financial affairs and the contractual obligations and benefits of the Society.
In carrying out this duty, the Finance Committee shall have full access to all financial records, financial information, or written agreements, or other records or documents of any kind of the Society and any Society businesses;
 - g. any other matter under Bylaw 900 within its jurisdiction.

Committee Procedures

4. In the event of a tie vote, the Chair shall cast the deciding vote.
5. Any member of the Finance Committee may call a Finance Committee Meeting by providing at least two (2) working days' notice of the date, time and location of the Finance Committee Meeting.
6. The Finance Committee shall make reports to Council regarding the expenditure of Society funds as set out in the Budget at the last Council meeting in the months of December, April, and August.

Bylaw 740 – Student Events Committee

Committee Mandate and Membership

1. The mandate of the Student Events Committee shall be to consider matters relating to Society Events;
2. The committee shall be composed of:
 - a. The Vice President (External), as Chair;
 - b. a minimum of two (2) Council Members appointed by Council.
 - c. any Member of the Society may be a Finance Committee Member if appointed by Council.
3. The Student Events Committee shall consider matters relating to the following subjects:
 - a. Cultural and Entertainment Events
 - b. Orientation Events
 - c. Social events for Members
 - d. Event Documents.

- i. Documents that shall be submitted to the DSU include the Primary Event Organizer and Event and Risk Management Information.
- ii. The Vice President External shall normally be the Primary Event Organizer.

Committee Procedures

4. In the event of a tie vote, the Chair shall cast the deciding vote.
5. Any member of the Students Events Committee may call a Student Events Committee Meeting by providing at least two (2) working days' notice of the date, time and location of the Student Events Committee Meeting.

Bylaw 800 – External Committees

General

1. The President and the Vice President (Internal) shall be voting members on the Lett Bursary Committee.
2. The President and the Vice President (Internal) shall attend the Meetings of the Department.
3. If there are external committees struck requiring a Member of Council to attend, the President shall normally represent the Society on the committee.
4. Members of these boards appointed under these Bylaws shall make regular reports to Council.

Lett Bursary Committee

5. If the President and/or the Vice President (Internal) is absent or has a conflict of interest with one of the Lett Bursary applicants, remaining Members of Council appointed by the Executive Committee must sit on the Lett Bursary Committee in their place.
6. The department chair may decide when a student representative has a conflict of interest. In such a case, the department chair may not disclose any reason or applicant information.
7. A student representative can remove themselves from the Lett Bursary at their discretion claiming a conflict of interest.

Bylaw 900 – Society Ratification

Ratification Document

1. The President shall complete the Ratification Document through the DSU Societies portal.
2. The ratification document shall be submitted no later than May.

Society Training

3. All the Executive Members shall attend risk management and space booking training sessions hosted by the DSU.
4. The President and Vice President Internal shall attend Treasurer Training hosted by the DSU.
5. Society Training shall be completed within the first three (3) months of being elected or appointed to office.

Bylaw 1000 - Society Finances

Society Budget

6. The finances of the Society shall be the responsibility of the Vice President (Internal), who shall supervise the Budget in consultation with the Executive Committee and the Finance Committee.
7. The Vice President (Internal) in consultation with the Executive Committee and the Finance Committee shall submit the Budget to Council for their review and decision.
8. Council is prohibited from approving a deficit budget.

Miscellaneous

9. The signing officers for any financial transaction will be the President, and the Vice Presidents.
10. At least two of the signing officers need to sign each cheque. An executive member cannot sign on a cheque made out to him/herself.
11. The bank account is held by the Vice President (Internal) who is responsible for invoicing of receipts and keeping of the ledger.
12. All financial books must be submitted to the DSU for audit.
13. The fiscal year of the Society shall commence 1 September and end on 31 August.

Conflict of Interest

14. If a member of Council or Finance Committee has a material interest in a contract or transaction that comes before Council or Finance Committee, they must:
 - a. Declare their material interest in the contract or transaction to the Council or Finance Committee, which shall be noted in the minutes;
 - b. Abstain from voting upon the contract or transaction in which one holds a material interest;
 - c. Not participate in discussion or debate, unless a motion specifically allowing them to do so is passed;
15. If a Member of the Society has a material interest in a contract or transaction that comes before Council or Finance Committee and wishes to speak on the topic at the meeting, the Member must declare one's interest in the contract or transaction before being allowed to speak.

Bylaw 1100 - General Meetings

Calling & Publicizing a General Meeting

1. The Council, in consultation with the President, shall schedule General Meetings of the Society on two (2) occasions during the year; one in September and one in February. Additional General Meetings may be scheduled by Council on a motion by the Executive Committee.
2. The Society shall publish notice of a General Meeting at least one week prior to the date of the General Meeting.

Meeting Procedures

3. The quorum for a General Meeting shall be ten (10) Members of the Society, three (3) of which must be Members of Council.
4. The Chair of the General Meeting shall be the President. If the President is unable to Chair, then the Council shall appoint a chair.
5. The Chair of the General Meeting shall be responsible for arranging and conducting the General Meeting in such a way that as many Members of the Society as possible, including Council Members, have the opportunity to speak.
6. The Vice President (Internal) shall take complete and accurate minutes of the proceedings of General Meetings. Such minutes shall be approved at the next General Meeting, and copies thereof shall be made available to every Council Member and to any other Member of the Society.
7. The governance documents of the Society are ranked as follows in terms of descending order of authority for the purposes of a General Meeting:
 - a. The Constitution of the Society;
 - b. The Bylaws of the Society;
 - c. The Policies of the Society;
 - d. Standing orders of Council;
 - e. Robert's Rules of Order.
8. Subject to any other provisions in the Bylaws, the following shall be, as far as practicable, the order of business at the General Meetings:
 - a. approval of the agenda;
 - b. approval of the minutes of the previous General Meeting;
 - c. unfinished business arising from the minutes;
 - d. reports of the Executive;
 - e. reports of the Committees;
 - f. question period;
 - g. presentation of any motions;
 - h. other business;
 - i. announcements; and
 - j. adjournment.

Voting at General Meetings

9. At any General Meeting, motions shall be considered and voted upon by the Members of the Society who are present including any Council Members.
10. Voting on all motions at a General Meeting shall be by a show of hands, except where the Bylaws or the Robert's Rules of Order require a secret ballot vote.

Motions passed at General Meetings

11. Passage of a motion by General Meeting shall become a policy of the Society for the term of the Council then in office and shall take effect on the day after the next regularly scheduled Council Meeting.
12. A General Meeting may, by 2/3 majority of Members of the Society who are present, rescind any motion of the Council then in office.
13. Motions may be recommended by a General Meeting in the absence of a quorum but such motions shall be considered only as advice to the next General Meeting and shall have no force or effect whatsoever.

Bylaw 1200 - Governance Documents

1. Unless otherwise stated in these Bylaws, the Governance Documents of the Society are ranked as follows in descending authority:
 - a. The Society Constitution;
 - b. The Bylaws of the Society;
 - c. The Policies of the Society;
 - d. Standing Rules of Council;
 - e. Robert's Rules of Order.

Adoption of New or Amended Bylaws and Policies

2. Only a General Meeting has the jurisdiction to adopt Bylaws.
3. Council or a General Meeting has the jurisdiction to adopt Policies, and Standing Rules of Council.
4. A motion respecting a Policy or Bylaw shall expressly contain in its text the resolution that Council or General meeting adopts said motion as a Policy or Bylaw.
5. New or Amended Bylaws, Policies and Standing Rules of Council take effect the day following their adoption by Council or General Meeting unless otherwise stated in the motion to adopt.
6. Amendments to the Bylaws or Policy Manual shall be made available to all Council Members and posted within a reasonable amount of time after they are approved.
7. No motion to amend the Election Rules shall be considered during the Election Period.

Constitution

8. Any requests to alter, amend, update, or otherwise change the Constitution shall only be passed by a more than 50% majority at a General Meeting.

Bylaws

9. All Bylaws shall be documented in the Bylaw Manual.
10. The Bylaws may only be amended during a General Meeting.
11. No motion to amend the Bylaws shall be considered without first allowing one (1) week's notice.

Policies

12. All Policies shall be documented in the Policy Manual.
13. A Policy shall take the form of a motion and shall be prefaced by a preamble which expresses the sentiment or principles on which the motion is based.
14. Policies may be introduced or amended at anytime throughout the year with a two-thirds majority vote in Council.

Standing Rules of Council

15. Standing Rules of Council shall be documented in the Resolutions Manual.
16. Standing Rules of Council may be introduced or amended at anytime throughout the year with a majority vote in Council.
17. Standing Rules of Council shall expire upon the Changeover of Council unless adopted by the incoming Council.